

Slow Polymorphism

A term occasionally applied to polymorphic viruses that only morph their code 'occasionally' rather than each time they replicate, as is more common. This is an 'anti-antivirus research' technique.

SMTP

Simple Mail Transport Protocol. The Internet e-mail delivery format for transmitting e-mail messages between servers.

Sniffer

A wiretap that eavesdrops on computer networks. The attacker must be between the sender and the receiver in order to sniff traffic. This is easy in corporations using shared media. Sniffers are frequently used as part of automated programs to sift information off the wire, such as clear-text passwords, and sometimes password hashes (to be cracked).

Social Engineering

There are two main ways to obtain technical or administrative information about a computer system. The first is from the systems themselves and the second is from the administrators and users of the machines. Surreptitious or unauthorised attempts to obtain such system information are known as hacking or cracking if the attempt involves obtaining information from the machines, and is called social engineering if the attempts involve manipulating or 'tricking' a person into divulging the information.

SOCKS Proxy

Socks (or SOCKS) is an IETF standard protocol for TCP/IP-based networking applications. A proxy server (a server that sits between a client application and a real server) can use SOCKS to accept requests from clients so that they can be forwarded across the Internet. Socks uses sockets to represent and keep track of individual connections.

SPAM Tool

Any software designed to extract e-mail addresses from Web sites